

[Home](#) > [Augusta County Sheriff Defends .005 Percent Success Rate Of Flock Cameras](#)

LOCAL

Augusta County sheriff defends .005 percent success rate of Flock cameras



Chris Graham

Published date: September 21, 2026 | 6:11 pm



Add as a preferred
source on Google



Share

Literally everybody in a position of political authority not named **Donald Trump** is trying to distance law enforcement from using **Flock cameras**. And then there's our elected **Augusta**



Augusta County Sheriff Donald Smith

case for Flock, he actually included in his presentation what he later called in a release a “video presented to the Board of Supervisors during today’s work session for more details about the Flock system” that comes straight from the **official YouTube page** of, you guessed it, **Flock!**

From the archives

- Coverage of the controversy over the use of Flock cameras: [click here](#).
-

Dear, gawd.

Scott Seaton, who represents the **Wayne District** on the Board Supervisors, where the two Flock cameras in operation in **Augusta County** are located, had noted, in a BOS meeting earlier this month, that the cameras had a low hit rate – Seaton said the two cameras had recorded, in the **30 days prior to the Sept. 9 Board of Supervisors meeting**, **eight hits** for cars that may have ties to some sort of crime from **more than 65,000 surveillance opportunities**.

The success rate there: **.01 percent**.

It was Seaton’s observations that led to Monday’s demonstration from the sheriff, which had Smith telling the BOS that the cameras “have already proven valuable in several investigations, including helping identify a suspect vehicle in the homicide of **Andrew W. Mitts Jr.**, locating stolen vehicles, assisting in missing-person cases, and supporting an investigation into a recent tire-dumping incident.”

That’s the anecdotal supportive evidence.

The data that the sheriff included in a release to local media outlets on total vehicle reads and agency searches generated by those reads proved Seaton’s point – the dataset reported **182 searches** from the **3,495,807 vehicle reads** for the **2026 year-to-date**, which would be a hit rate of **.005 percent**.

For reference: a **1 percent hit rate** would be **34,958 hits**.

A **.1 percent hit rate** would be **3,496 hits**.

Even a **.01 percent hit rate** would be **350 hits**.

We’re talking *half of .01 percent* here.

respect those concerns,” Smith said, in a statement in a release from his office. “The Flock system is secured to meet federal and military standards. Access to the system is strictly controlled, monitored, and logged. This system is then audited by the **Sheriff’s Office** and the **Virginia State Police**. Additionally, Virginia law makes it clear that misuse or improper access is prohibited. Under **Virginia Code §2.2-5517(D)**, there are penalties for abusing the system.”

The penalties only come into play if somebody finds out the system is being abused; and who do you report abuse to, the Sheriff’s Office?

Sure, *they’re* going to make sure they’re not breaking the law.

“Augusta County is a large community with limited law enforcement resources, and technology like Flock cameras can help investigators work cases more efficiently,” Smith said, failing to acknowledge the massive inefficiency of the cameras, though he did go on to concede, shockingly, that “it is important that we carefully consider privacy and make sure any technology we use is handled responsibly.”

“I want our citizens to know that I am listening,” Smith said. “I will continue to review how the system is used, weigh its benefits and limitations, and thoughtfully consider community concerns before making decisions about Flock cameras’ future usage in Augusta County.

“I ask for your patience as we work through these issues,” the sheriff went on. “My goal is to keep Augusta County safe while maintaining the trust and confidence of the people we serve. Thank you for continuing to share your thoughts, questions, and concerns. I am committed to protecting our community while respecting the rights, privacy and freedoms of everyone.”

No, he’s not.

FEATURED VIDEO

[News](#)

[Politics](#)

[Sports](#)

[Go
'Hoos](#)

[Business
Wire](#)

[Subscribe](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Our
Team](#)

Tags

FLOCK CAMERAS

Chris Graham

Chris Graham is the founder and editor of *Augusta Free Press*. A 1994 alum of the University of Virginia, Chris is the author and co-author of seven books, including *Poverty of Imagination*, a memoir published in 2019. For his commentaries on news, sports and politics, go to his [YouTube page](#), [TikTok](#), [BlueSky](#), or subscribe to his [Street Knowledge podcast](#). Email Chris at chris@augustafreepress.com.

[View all posts by Chris Graham](#)

LOCAL

Augusta County sheriff defends .005 percent success rate of Flock cameras



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

Debra Freeman to offer perspectives on homelessness at Lunch & Learn event



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

Waynesboro Public Library art exhibit highlights issues with domestic abuse



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

Overnight closure on Interstate 81 in Staunton area tonight, into wee hours Sunday



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

William Perry Elementary School student found with BB gun in bookbag



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 18, 2026

Harrisonburg teen charged with making threat to Westwood Hills Elementary School



CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 18, 2026

ICYMI

- 1 Did Waynesboro Schools really hire the superintendent's former romantic partner?
- 2 UVA Football: Why do you play games that you know will end up 59-3?
- 3 Augusta County supervisors want to revisit the future of our Flock cameras
- 4 Waynesboro: Mimosa Farm owner asks for delay in vote on permit application
- 5 UVA Football: Tony Elliott, egged on by local media, falls on his sword for Michael Vick, again

LATEST NEWS

News

Politics

Sports

Go
'Hoos

Business
Wire

Subscribe

Advertise

Our
Team

FOOTBALL, GO 'HOOS

UVA Football: How much money did we get for that beatdown in Charlotte?

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

REGION/STATE

Danville Police officer arrested, placed on leave, in connection with shooting

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

FOOTBALL

ACC Football: Players of the Week for Week 3, from the select media panel

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

LOCAL

Debra Freeman to offer perspectives on homelessness at Lunch & Learn event

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

TRUMP'S AMERICA

FAA rolls out AI air traffic control in DC: NoVa congressman fights back

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

REGION/STATE

Charlottesville community group raising issues with proposed Dairy Market expansion

CHRIS GRAHAM SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

[News](#)

[Politics](#)

[Sports](#)

[Go
'Hoos](#)

[Business
Wire](#)

[Subscribe](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Our
Team](#)

[APP](#)

[APP](#)

[Health](#)

[Policy](#)

Copyright © 2026 Augusta Free Press LLC. All Rights Reserved.